

Migration Sign-off Checklist

What to agree before the mock load, check during reconciliation, and confirm before finance signs.

- 1 Before mock load
- 2 During reconciliation
- 3 Before sign-off

For programme directors, data migration leads, finance transformation leads, controllers and ERP consultants.

Before mock load (1/3)

☐ Named owner

One person accountable for the reconciliation, not 'the team'.

Why: Unowned breaks don't get closed.

☐ Source of truth

Agree which system, report and cut-off is the baseline for each dataset.

Why: Otherwise every difference turns into an argument about which number is right.

☐ Matching key

Define what makes two records 'the same', e.g. invoice no. + vendor, or employee ID + pay period.

Why: Without a key you can only compare totals.

Before mock load (2/3)

☐ Expected differences

List the known, accepted differences up front: rounding, remapped codes, items deliberately not migrated.

Why: Differences nobody listed will look like defects.

☐ Tolerances

Set the acceptable variance at each level, e.g. zero on counts, pennies on account balances.

Why: It stops 'close enough' debates at sign-off.

☐ Required control totals

Record counts and value totals per file, entity and period, taken at the same cut-off on both sides.

Why: They're the first and cheapest sign that something's wrong.

Before mock load (3/3)

☐ Exception categories

Missing, duplicate, value, timing, definition.

Why: Each category has a different cause, owner and fix.

☐ Rerun process

How a fix gets re-extracted, re-loaded and re-compared, and who triggers it.

Why: If a fix can't be proved again, it isn't finished.

☐ Sign-off authority

Who signs, what evidence they need, and by when.

Why: Sign-off slips when the signer first sees the evidence on sign-off day.

During reconciliation (1/2)

☐ Record counts

Compare by file, entity and period.

Why: Catches dropped, filtered or double-loaded batches.

☐ Value totals

Sum the key amounts on both sides.

Why: Counts can match while the values don't.

☐ Account-level comparison

Compare balances by account, entity and period.

Why: Puts each break where finance will look for it.

☐ Document-level comparison

Match on the business key, record by record.

Why: Finds the compensating errors that totals hide.

During reconciliation (2/2)

☐ Missing records

In source, not in target.

Why: Often a filter, mapping or reject file nobody read.

☐ Duplicates

The same key more than once in the target.

Why: Reruns and bad joins double-count quietly.

☐ Value breaks

Matched records with different amounts.

Why: Usually a mapping, currency or rounding rule.

☐ Timing differences

The right record in the wrong period or on the wrong side of cut-off.

Why: They can be explained, but only against an agreed cut-off.

Before sign-off (1/2)

☐ Unresolved differences

Count and value of the open breaks, by category.

Why: Finance signs off on what's left, not on what was fixed.

☐ Explained differences

Each one tied to the expected-differences list or a written reason.

Why: A verbal explanation doesn't count as evidence.

☐ Ownership

Every open item has a named owner and a target date.

Why: Unowned exceptions become hypercare incidents.

Before sign-off (2/2)

☐ Evidence

A source-to-target bridge and an exception pack, stored and reproducible.

Why: The signer, and later the auditors, need to see how each number was reached.

☐ Rerun status

The latest fixes have been re-run and re-compared.

Why: Sign off the data that will actually go live.

☐ Finance acceptance

An explicit, recorded decision by the sign-off authority, with any conditions.

Why: Silence isn't sign-off.

Classify every break

Missing	In source, not in target
Duplicate	In target more than once
Value	Matched, different amount
Timing	Right record, different period or cut-off
Definition	Both "right", measured differently

**Agree the rules before mock 1.
Sign off on evidence, not on a green load.**

Free to use and share. Save it for your next mock load or parallel run.